

Recommended Consolidated Rubric

Eight scoring dimensions. Each includes: definition, machine-detectable voice/transcript signals, applicable case stage(s), and strong/adequate/weak behavioral anchors.

Case stages referenced: (1) Opening/Framework, (2) Analysis/Math, (3) Data/Exhibit interpretation, (4) Brainstorming, (5) Synthesis/Recommendation. Several dimensions span all stages.

Dimension 1 — Problem Structuring

- **Definition:** Ability to break an ambiguous problem into a logical, MECE, tailored structure that fits the specific objective (not a memorized template).
- **Stage:** Opening/Framework (primary); reused throughout via signposting.
- **Detectable signals:** explicit enumeration of buckets ("three areas..."); coverage breadth vs. overlap; tailoring words tied to the specific client/industry; statement of the objective before the structure; a stated prioritization ("I'd start with X because...").
- **Strong:** Objective restated; 3–4 tailored, non-overlapping buckets with brief sub-points; prioritizes where the answer likely lives; ties structure to the decision.
- **Adequate:** Recognizable relevant framework, mostly MECE, limited tailoring; no clear prioritization.
- **Needs Work:** Generic memorized template (e.g., unmodified Porter/4P), overlapping or missing buckets, no objective, or jumps to analysis with no structure.

Dimension 2 — Quantitative & Analytical Rigor

- **Definition:** Accurate, well-organized math (mental math, market sizing, consulting math) with verbalized setup and sanity-checking.
- **Stage:** Analysis/Math (primary); Brainstorming (sizing).
- **Detectable signals:** stated approach before calculating; step-by-step verbalization; correct arithmetic; unit tracking; explicit sanity check; reasonable assumptions named.
- **Strong:** Lays out the equation first, computes accurately, narrates steps, sanity-checks the result, states the business implication of the number.
- **Adequate:** Reaches a correct or near-correct answer with some verbalization; minor errors self-caught or immaterial; limited sanity check.
- **Needs Work:** Silent calculation, arithmetic errors uncorrected, disorganized setup, unreasonable assumptions, no interpretation of the result.

Dimension 3 — Data & Exhibit / Chart Interpretation

- **Definition:** Extracting the key pattern/anomaly from a chart or table and translating it into a business implication.
- **Stage:** Data/Exhibit interpretation (primary).

- **Detectable signals:** orients first (title/axes/units); identifies the main insight or outlier; states a "so-what"; proposes a next step.
- **Strong:** Reads the exhibit systematically, isolates the driver/anomaly, states implication and next step ("...so I'd next check...").
- **Adequate:** Correctly reads the data and notes a relevant point but weak on implication or next step.
- **Needs Work:** Merely restates numbers ("revenue is up 12%") with no insight, or misreads the exhibit.

Dimension 4 — Business Judgment & Insight

- **Definition:** Commercial sense — reasonable assumptions, practical/implementable ideas, awareness of risks and real-world dynamics.
- **Stage:** All stages; concentrated in Analysis and Synthesis.
- **Detectable signals:** references to realistic business levers; risk/caveat mentions; feasibility comments; prioritization by impact; assumptions that pass a plausibility check.
- **Strong:** Recommendations are practical and commercially sound; proactively surfaces risks and mitigations; assumptions are realistic and justified.
- **Adequate:** Generally sensible judgment; some generic or unprioritized ideas; limited risk awareness.
- **Needs Work:** Impractical or non-viable suggestions; ignores risks; assumptions clearly unrealistic.

Dimension 5 — Creativity & Brainstorming

- **Definition:** Generating a structured breadth of relevant, non-obvious ideas.
- **Stage:** Brainstorming (primary); Synthesis (options).
- **Detectable signals:** explicit mini-structure for the brainstorm ("I'll split ideas into organic vs. inorganic..."); number and diversity of ideas; presence of at least one non-obvious idea.
- **Strong:** Organizes ideas into buckets, produces several distinct ideas including non-obvious ones, then prioritizes.
- **Adequate:** Several relevant ideas but flat/unstructured or conventional.
- **Needs Work:** Few ideas, all obvious, no structure, or dries up quickly.

Dimension 6 — Synthesis & Recommendation

- **Definition:** A concise, answer-first recommendation supported by evidence, risks, and next steps.
- **Stage:** Synthesis/Recommendation (primary); mini-syntheses after each analysis segment.
- **Detectable signals:** conclusion stated first; 2–3 supporting reasons; explicit risk/caveat; next steps; brevity (e.g., ~60–90 seconds).

- **Strong:** Leads with a clear recommendation, gives 2–3 reasons tied to the analysis, names key risk and next steps, stays concise.
- **Adequate:** Clear conclusion with some support but wordy, missing risks or next steps, or partially buried.
- **Needs Work:** No committed answer ("there are arguments on both sides"), rambling, or a summary that merely recaps without recommending.

Dimension 7 — Communication & Delivery (voice-critical)

- **Definition:** Top-down, signposted, clear verbal communication with good pacing and active listening.
- **Stage:** All stages.
- **Detectable signals:** answer-first ordering; signposting/discourse markers; hypothesis language; explicit structure narration; controlled pace and pauses vs. filler density; not interrupting.
- **Strong:** Consistently top-down and signposted; states structure before detail; hypothesis-driven phrasing; calm, well-paced; listens and builds on cues.
- **Adequate:** Mostly clear and followable; intermittent signposting; some rambling or filler.
- **Needs Work:** Bottom-up/meandering, no signposting, hard to follow, heavy filler, talks over the interviewer, or long silences.

Dimension 8 — Handling Pushback, Composure & Case Leadership

- **Definition:** Responding to challenges with poise and evaluative logic (update or hold with reasons); driving the case forward (candidate-led) or answering the precise question crisply (interviewer-led); coachability.
- **Stage:** All stages; challenges typically in Analysis and Synthesis.
- **Detectable signals:** acknowledges challenge specifically; restates position with evidence; states what changed vs. what holds; proactively proposes next steps; asks for relevant data; incorporates feedback in subsequent turns.
- **Strong:** Acknowledges the challenge, holds or updates with explicit reasoning (no reflexive capitulation, no defensiveness); drives next steps; visibly incorporates hints.
- **Adequate:** Handles the challenge reasonably but either concedes a little too fast or defends slightly rigidly; moderate proactivity.
- **Needs Work:** Caves immediately to any pushback or becomes defensive; passive/waits to be led; ignores hints/feedback.

Rubric-to-stage matrix (implementation aid)

Dimension	Open/Framework	Analysis/Mat h	Data/Exhibit	Brainstorm	Synthesis
1 Structuring	●	○ (signpost)	○	○ (mini-structure)	○
2 Quant rigor		●		● (sizing)	○
3 Data/exhibit		○	●		○
4 Business judgment	○	●	○	●	●
5 Creativity				●	○
6 Synthesis/rec		○ (mini)	○ (mini)		●
7 Communication	●	●	●	●	●
8 Pushback/leadership	○	●	●	○	●

(● primary, ○ secondary)